

Externalizing Crises: Internal Collapse → External Aggression

Historical Precedents

Britain 1873-1914

Internal: Long Depression (1873-1896), labor movements
External: "Scramble for Africa" → controlled 1/4 of the globe

Japan 1930s

Internal: Great Depression crushed export economy, resource dependency
External: "Greater East Asia Co-Prosperty Sphere" → Pacific War

Argentina 1982

Internal: Triple-digit inflation, GDP collapse, military junta crisis
External: Invaded Falklands → Failed → Junta collapsed

Russia 2022-

Internal: Economic stagnation, demographic decline
External: Invaded Ukraine → Trapped in war economy (30-40% of budget)

Pattern: economic crisis + military advantage + political pressure = external conflict

The AI-Era Scenario

Mass AI layoffs



Internal crisis erupts



AI military at peak



External resource extraction
to relieve internal pressure

Thucydides Trap (Graham Allison, Harvard)

Of 16 historical "rising power vs ruling power" cases, 12 ended in war (75%)

AI accelerates every factor: tech gap up · resource competition up · domestic pressure up · military threshold down

AI-Era Strategic Flashpoints

Taiwan

70% advanced chips

China Rare Earths

69% global mining + processing

Congo Cobalt/Lithium

US secured priority access

Greenland Minerals

"Tempting target for AI race"

Arctic

Rare earths + energy